

Rafael Campos-Gottardo

McGill University

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INTRODUCTION

- Over three years of quantitative research assistantships with experience analyzing observational, experimental, and textual data.
- Experience teaching and using R including, functionalizing code and creating replication packages.
- Experience with Python for machine learning, textual analysis, and data visualization.
- Extensive quantitative methods training in linear and logistic regression, causal inference, machine learning techniques for textual analysis, and panel data analysis from McGill University and the ICPSR Summer Program at the University of Michigan.

EDUCATION

McGill University

M.A. in Political Science

Advisor: Aaron Erlich

Thesis: “The Impact of Political Violence on Levels of Polarization: Evidence from a Natural Experiment”

Montréal, QC

2023 – 2025 *exp.*

University of Michigan

ICPSR Summer Program

Courses: Panel Data and Longitudinal Analysis; Text Analysis and Data Science

Lectures: Matrix Algebra, Calculus, and Probability; Introduction to Python

Ann Arbor, MI

Jul. 2024 – Aug. 2024

Wilfrid Laurier University

B.A. in Political Science *with high distinction*; GPA: 3.9/4.0 - Alumni Gold Medal

Minor in History

Undergraduate MRP: “The Puzzle of Centrist Populism: An analysis of Nayib Bukele in El Salvador”

Waterloo, ON

2019 – 2023

RESEARCH AFFILIATIONS & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Centre for the Study of Democratic Citizenship

Aaron Erlich

2023 – present

- Created codebooks for multi-wave surveys using the `codebook` package in R.
- Followed a pre-analysis plan for the *Journal of Experimental Political Science* for an experiment conducted in Ukraine and created replication materials in R.
- Conducted difference-in-difference analysis a conjoint experiment measuring Ukrainian’s support for compromise in two waves.
- Analyzed a pre-registered factorial experiment examining the preferences of Ukrainians regarding the type of organizations with which they would be willing to volunteer.
- Wrote and provided analysis for a variety of projects in multiple disciplines including political science and criminology using data collected in Ukraine during the war.

Dietlind Stolle

2024

- Reviewed multi-language Qualtrics surveys to ensure that question wording and survey flow were correctly inputted.
- Created a dataset measuring the partisan composition of government cabinets in 16 European countries at two time points in 2023 using government databases and cross referencing ministers party affiliation.

Laurier Institute for the Study of Public Opinion and Policy

Simon Kiss

2022 – present

- Co-authored a conference paper to introduce a novel dataset collected during the 2018 Ontario Election Study and provide a sample analysis on the correlation between polarization and social media usage in Ontario.
- Created a novel dataset of occupations in the Canadian election study using *Statistics Canada's* national occupations codes (NOC), and conducted sample analysis.
- Taught lessons on OLS regression to undergraduate research assistants.
- Mentored undergraduate students in the completion of a poster using a difference-in-difference model to estimate the effect of the closure of Laurentian university on vote choice in the 2021 Ontario Election. Mentoring included teaching lessons on OLS regression and causal inference.
- Analyzed an experiment to determine the effect of appeals (public goods, personal goods) on support for housing developments.
- Created a new question to capture occupations using *JavaScript* in *Qualtrics* to be included in the **Canadian Election Study**.

PUBLICATIONS

In Progress

- [1] “War Fatigue” with Aaron Erlich
- [2] “Recoding Occupations from the Canadian Election Study” with Simon Kiss
- [3] “Civic Engagement in Rebuilding Ukraine: Observational and Experimental Evidence” with Aaron Erlich & Dietlind Stolle

Forthcoming

- [1] “Housing, Healthcare, and More: Decoding the 2022 Ontario General Election” Forthcoming in *The Canadian Political Science Review*, with Andrea Perrella & Simon Kiss.

Reports & Non-Peer Reviewed Publications

- [2] **Campos-Gottardo, R.** (2022). Populism, inequality, and Lëvizja Vetëvendosje in Kosovo: Shaping society through populist discourses. *Undergraduate Journal of Politics, Policy, and Society (University of Ottawa)*, 5(1), 56-90.
- [1] **Campos-Gottardo, R.** & Tenaglia, D. (2021). Forms of corruption within the Canadian judicial branch. *The Lawyer-Ed Law Review*, 1(1), 16-21.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

* Indicates presenting author; † indicates student

- [8] Lehecka, N[†], Thomson, B[†], **Campos-Gottardo, R.**, & Kiss, S. (2025, June). Did The Ford Government Suffer Any Electoral Backlash From the Laurentian University Bankruptcy? **Poster presentation accepted:** Canadian Political Science Association, Toronto, ON.
- [7] **Campos-Gottardo, R.**, Arp, M., Gravelle, T., Kiss, S., Piscitelli, A., & Spicer, Z. (authors in alphabetical order) (2025, June). Do appeals to benefits overcome NIMBY-ISM?. **Paper presentation accepted:** Canadian Political Science Association, Toronto, ON.
- [6] Erlich, A.,* Stolle, D., & **Campos-Gottardo, R.** (2024, June). Civic Engagement in Rebuilding Ukraine: Observational and Experimental Evidence. **Paper presentation:** Canadian Political Science Association, Montréal, QC.
- [5] **Campos-Gottardo, R.**,* & Kiss, S.* (2024, June). Social Media Use and Polarization in Ontario: 2018 Case Study. **Paper presentation:** Canadian Political Science Association, Montréal, QC.
- [4] **Campos-Gottardo, R.*** (2024, January). Correlates of Populist Attitudes in Canada: Evidence from the CES. **Paper presentation:** Bell Chair Graduate Student Conference, Ottawa, ON.
- [3] **Campos-Gottardo, R.*** & Perrella, A. (2023, May). The Role of Populist Attitudes on Support for Centrist Populist Candidates: Evidence From El Salvador. **Poster presentation:** Canadian Political Science Association, Toronto, ON.

[2] **Campos-Gottardo, R.*** (2022, August). Populism and authoritarianism during the COVID-19 pandemic: The case of Nayib Bukele in El Salvador. **Paper presentation:** Congress of the Canadian Association for Latin American and Caribbean Studies, Toronto, ON.

[1] **Campos-Gottardo, R.***, Jasemi, A., & Gottardo, A. (2022, June). Parenting beliefs about the importance of politics and child qualities: Similarities and differences across borders. **Poster presentation:** Development 2022, Calgary, AB.

AWARDS & ACHIEVEMENTS

CSDC - Summer Methods Grant, 2024 (\$3,000)
FRQ-SC Master’s Scholarship, 2024 (\$26,667)
Stolle Graduate Award, 2024 (\$2,500)
SSHRC Canada Graduate Scholarship – Master’s, 2023 (\$17,500)
Library Research Award – First Prize, Senior Division, 2023 (\$350)
Harry and Lillian Kay Scholarship, 2022 (\$1,000)
Menich Family Co-op Award, 2022 (\$6,300)

TEACHING & TEACHING ASSISTANCE

- Three years of experience teaching statistical analysis in R and SPSS to labs of 20-40 students.
- Prepared lesson plans and written lab guides on fitting, interpreting, and visualizing linear and logistic regression models in R.
- Graded R lab assignments and quantitative research papers.

McGill University

POLI311 - Introduction to Quantitative Methods	Winter 2024 & (Head TA) 2025
POLI210 - Political Science Research Methods	Fall 2024
CDSI/CSDC - R Summer Camp	August 2024

Wilfrid Laurier University

PO479 - Seminar on Research Design - Guest Lecture on Quantitative Causal Inference	February 2025
PO218 - Answering Questions in Political Science	Winter 2023
PO217 - Asking Questions in Political Science	Fall 2022

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Fundraising Coordinator , Canadian Landmine Foundation	May – August, 2022
Policy Analyst, Industrial Benefits , FedDev Canada	May – August, 2021
Student Outreach Officer (Citizen Services Branch) , Service Canada	June – December, 2020

SKILLS

Technical: R, $\LaTeX$, Python
Languages: English (Native), French (Professional)